

Platform Description: Experience-First Tourist Assistant for Victoria Falls

Overview

The platform is a destination-specific, experience-driven tourist assistant designed primarily for foreign visitors to Victoria Falls, Zimbabwe. Its purpose is to help tourists discover places, activities, lodges, and experiences that truly match what they want to feel and experience, rather than limiting them to only the most popular or heavily marketed attractions.

Unlike traditional travel platforms that prioritize popularity, ratings, or generic itineraries, this platform focuses on personalized discovery and hidden-gem exposure, ensuring visitors enjoy a richer, more authentic Victoria Falls experience.

Problem Statement

Most tourists visiting Victoria Falls have limited local knowledge, rely heavily on Google Maps or similar platforms, and often end up visiting only well-known and overcrowded attractions. As a result, many unique, culturally rich, and niche experiences remain undiscovered.

Existing platforms are optimized for scale and popularity rather than experience quality or personal intent.

Proposed Solution

The platform acts as an intelligent experience-matching assistant. Instead of asking tourists where they want to go, it asks what they want to experience in Victoria Falls, then matches that intent to relevant places and activities.

Core Concept

The platform combines three layers: maps as a discovery tool, an experience intelligence layer for matching and ranking, and curated descriptions that evolve through user feedback.

How It Works

Users describe what they want to experience. The platform analyzes the input, matches it against experience-tagged places, and presents 5–10 tailored recommendations grouped by category. Each recommendation explains why it fits the user's expectations and is labeled as popular, hidden gem, or local favorite.

Key Features (MVP)

- Free-text experience input
- Experience-based recommendation engine
- Maps integration for location awareness
- Balanced discovery logic
- Tourist-friendly explanations
- Mobile-friendly web interface

Target Users

Foreign tourists, first-time visitors, and experience-driven travelers seeking authentic and personalized exploration of Victoria Falls.

Differentiation

This is not a booking site or a generic travel planner. It is an experience discovery assistant focused on local depth, hidden gems, and meaningful travel experiences.

Technical & Cost Strategy

The MVP uses low-cost or free mapping solutions such as Mapbox or OpenStreetMap to minimize expenses.

Richer APIs can be introduced later once user demand is validated.

Vision

The long-term vision is to create a trusted digital guide for Victoria Falls that can later be replicated for other destinations, improving tourist satisfaction while promoting equitable tourism development.

One-Sentence Summary

An experience-first tourist assistant for Victoria Falls that helps visitors discover personalized, authentic, and lesser-known places using maps for discovery and intelligence for meaning.